In rupee terms, infrastructure investment crossed Rs 2 lakh crore in 2005–06, Rs 3 lakh crore in 2007–08, Rs 4 lakh crore in 2008–09 and Rs 6 lakh crore in 2010–11. In less than five years between 2005–06 and 2010–11, infrastructure investment trebled in terms of rupees and by more than 60 per cent in terms of ratio to GDP. Investment in infrastructure during the first decade of the current millennium was on a roll.

Private investment in infrastructure also took off notably from 2006–07. From a little less than 1.5 per cent of GDP in 2006–07, it grew massively to rise to a little less than 4 per cent of GDP by 2010–11. Public investment kept pace with the growth in GDP and ranged between 4 per cent and 5 per cent of GDP all through this period, which coincided almost entirely with the Eleventh Plan period.

The CSO/National Statistical Office (NSO)/Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI) has stopped publishing Infrastructure Statistics after 2014.

Investment Slackening for Some Time

Infrastructure Statistics 2014 noted that investment started falling from the year 2011–12. In rupee terms, it fell to less than Rs 5.5 lakh crore; in terms of ratio to GDP, it declined to less than 7 per cent.

With the stoppage of Infrastructure Statistics by the Planning Commission/NITI Aayog, there is no authentic and comparable data available for infrastructure investment in India—it has to be estimated indirectly. All infrastructure investments are part of GFCF, or gross fixed capital formation. In particular, the Dwellings, Other Buildings and Structures (DOBS) part of GFCF (the other three parts are Machinery and Equipment, Cultivated Biological Resources and Intellectual Property Products) is a close proxy for infrastructure investment although some part of this component also represents fixed investment in manufacturing and other sectors of the economy.